

Lonely Son

Written by

Burt Burlington

Address
Phone Number

INT. HOUSE BEDROOM SON - EVENING

The wall is covered with posters of superheroes, Magic the Gathering and various animes. On a messy desk stands a computer with RGB lights and a expensive wide monitor. On the desk are Funko pops, figurines of dragons and anime girls with revealing outfits. Between the collectibles are empty chips bags and soda bottles. The curtains are closed and the only light comes from the big monitor. A cartoon of medieval characters called "DragonQuesters", is playing on the monitor, lighting up the SON (27, overweight, messy hair, unshaven, glasses, tall, shorts) sitting behind the computer.

He is watching the cartoon with his RGB headphones on.

The bedroom door opens and a harsh bright light flows into the room, almost blinding Son.

With a lightning yet stoic fast reaction , Son pauses video and takes off his headset.

Turns to FATHER (59, balding, glasses, dad body, shorter than son) standing in the doorway.

SON

Hey dad.

Father STEPS inside.

FATHER

Everything okay here, son?

SON

Yeah, fine.

Father nods carefully. Walks towards the bed with Spiderman bedsheets. While walking he looks on the ground at the dirty clothes and candy wrappers.

Son follows dad around the room with his eyes.

When Father reaches the bed, he has trouble sitting down due to his old age.

Father exhales.

FATHER

(positively)

And? Any plans for the weekend?

Father leans forward, holding his hands on his knees.

SON

Nah

Father pretends to be surprised.

FATHER
No, not gonna hang out with your
friends?

Son SIGHS, scratches back of neck.

SON
Nah, everyone was busy.

Father looks away nods, and swallows.
Looks back at son.

FATHER
(compassionately)
Ah, that is frustrating.

Son looks down at the floor.

SON
Yeah...

FATHER
(curious)
And how is it going with the girls?

SON
Dad...

Father steps up from the bed.
Holds his hands in front of him.

FATHER
(laugh)
Sorry.

Dad WALKS back to the door.
Stops in his tracks.

FATHER (CONT'D)
Okay buddy, if you ever need a lift
or want to borrow the car, just ask

SON
Thanks dad.

Father SNIFFS, curls his lip inside his mouth.
He nods.

FATHER
Well. Have fun with what you're
doing

SON

Will do.

Son turns his stool back to the monitor.
In one smooth motion he starts the video and puts on his headphones.

Father closes the door, pulling in all the light again.

INT. HOUSE BEDROOM SON

With a blank stare Son is watching the cartoon.

His hand is reaching inside a bag of chips, but the bag floats up.
Son frowns, CRUMBLES up the BAG and THROWS it behind him.

He stands up.

INT. HOUSE STAIRS

On the wall beside the stairs are framed pictures of a woman, a family of five, Father etc. It's dark downstairs.

Son WALKS DOWN the STAIRS.

We hear someone SOBBING.

INT. HOUSE KITCHEN

The kitchen has a dinner table in the middle of the kitchen.
The only light that is burning on the first floor is the lamp above the dinner table.

At the dinner table Father is sitting, browsing through the family picture book.
He is CRYING. He is looking through pictures of Son when he was young, his brothers wedding, other brother hanging out with friends etc.

Son stands behind the doorway, looking at his Father.

SON

Dad?

Quickly, Father wipes off his tears.
He turns to his son as if nothing happened.

FATHER

Yeah, what's up buddy?

SON

Me and some friends of mine are
going out. Can I still borrow the
car?

Father lights up, jumps up from his chair.

FATHER

Of course son!

Father stretches out his arms and comes in for a hug.
The father is dwarfed by his son when they hug.

FATHER (CONT'D)

No worries, let me grab the keys.

Father let's go of his son and walks to the living room.

EXT. HOUSE DRIVEWAY

The streetlights have been on for some time in the quiet
suburb.

Son is DRIVING in reverse, exiting the driveway.

While reversing, he sees his father standing in the window
waving him goodbye.

Son smiles painfully.

EXT. PARKING LOT - NIGHT

An empty parking lot is connected to a gas station,
supermarket and a fast food chain restaurant.

In the middle of the parking lot the Son is sitting in the
car.

A bright white light from his phone shines into his face.
He is surfing internet forums.

The screen turns black and a red dead battery pictogram.
The screen turns black.

Son looks frustrated. Looks around the parking lot and sees a
group of teenagers smoking weed.

Son RECLINES CHAIR.

He lays his hands on his chest and closes his eyes.

EXT. PARKING LOT - MORNING

Son is woken up by the sunlight that is shines in his face.

INT. HOUSE KITCHEN

Father is having breakfast at the dinner table.

Son comes home through the back door and is greeted by his Father smiling.

FATHER
Long night, had fun?

SON
Yeah, it was great.

FATHER
Great!

Son TRUDGES in.

FATHER (CONT'D)
You better get some sleep now, you
must be tired after such a night.

Son nods while walking to the living room.

INT. HOUSE BEDROOM SON

The bedroom is messy and the curtains are closed.
It is a dark abyss.

Son TRUDGES to his bed and PLUNCHES onto his BED.

With his eyes wide open, he stares at a blank ceiling.

INT. HOUSE BEDROOM SON - EVENING

Son is sitting behind his monitor, watching an colourful anime. He is in the process of eating chips.

ALARM CLOCK RINGS on SON's MOBILE PHONE. Alarm reads 8 PM.
He wipes the grease off his fingers with his grey t-shirt and dismisses the alarm clock.

INT. HOUSE STAIRS

Son walks down stairs.

INT. HOUSE KITCHEN

Father is assembling a puzzle on the dinner table.

Son stands in the door opening.

SON

Dad, can I borrow the car again?

Dad turns to his Son.

FATHER

Of course, you know where they are.

Son walks back into the living room while his dad looks at him with a smile.

EXT. HOUSE DRIVE WAY

Son reverses onto the street in his Father's car.

EXT. PARKING LOT - NIGHT

Son is asleep in the driver's seat.

MONTAGE

- Son sitting behind his computer, ALARM CLOCK RINGS.
- Son walking down stairs
- Grabs keys
- Smiling/waving Father
- Reversing off the drive way
- Sleeping in parking lot

X3 times fast

EXT. PARKING LOT - NIGHT

Son is sitting in the driver's seat with a "DragonQuesters' shirt.

His STOMACH RUMBLES.

He looks around the parking lot.

In the distance he spots a fast food restaurant.
A group of cosplayers dressed as knights, wolves, elves are entering restaurant

INT. FAST FOOD RESTAURANT

The restaurant has white tiles on the walls and bright blue and red colours.

The costumers are spread thinly around the restaurant, besides a small group of cosplayers, LARPerS and role players dressed like their characters. It is therefore quiet and dead, apart from the NERDY TALKING COSPLAY GROUP.

Son walks into the restaurant and walks passed the cosplay party.

He stands next to self-order kiosk and starts placing his order.

When choosing what burger he wants, a GIRL (25, glasses, white flutter sleeve top, witch hat) pokes him in the back. Son gets STARTLED, looks back in angst. Girl is smiling sweet and looks up at Son.

GIRL

I like your shirt.

She looks up at him without breaking eye contact. He looks down at his shirt and back at her.

SON

Thanks...

She looks at him with a sweet smile.

GIRL

You watch DragonQuesters too?

Son scratches his neck.

SON

Yeah I watch it. I have just finished watching season 9.

GIRL

(rapidly, enthusiastic)

Us too! We were discussing how Gruckleston was way different than he was in season 1. But I think he acts like that because he was cursed by Matild in season 6 in the Orc Castle.

SON

Yeah I thought so too... But in the last season Troglift tells about the symptoms of the Yiram spell is depression and solemnness.

GIRL

When did he say that, what episode?

SON
Episode 6: Orc-galore, if I am
correct.

She is standing on her tippy toes because of her enthusiasm.

GIRL
Really?! I didn't know that.

She drops back on the balls of her feet.

GIRL (CONT'D)
You want to join us?
We love to talk to you about DQ.

SON
Yeah... sure.
By the way, I love your hat

She GIGGLES.

GIRL
(High pitched)
Thank you!
Let me introduce you to everyone.

She walks back to her friends.
They sit down with their friends while they have been
CONTINUING TALKING ABOUT DRAGONQUESTERS.

FADE TO:

INT. HOUSE KITCHEN - EVENING

Father is sitting at the dinner table reading the paper.

He hears SON WALKING up.

He THROWS the KEYS to SON behind him.
Son CATCHES them.

SON
Sorry dad, not tonight.

Father turns around disappointed.

FATHER
Why not, what's wrong?

SON
Cause I wanted to ask if I could
have friends over tonight.

Father lights up just as much as he did the first evening.

FATHER

Of course, of course you can!

Son smiles back at his Father.

INT. HOUSE KITCHEN - NIGHT

The entire table is turned into a Roleplay dreamscape with maps, mini figures, character paper sheets, all kinds of dice, cardboard artworks. Around the table are all the people Son met at the fast food restaurant. Son is sitting beside the Girl with the witch hat. Behind a cardboard sheet is the GAME MASTER (30, balding, glasses, black shirt with fantasy artwork, beard)

GAME MASTER

(enthusiastic)

Paladin, you are being grappled by the Beast of Torture, what is your next move.

SON

(excited, stressed)

Uuuh. I use my fire blast!

GAME MASTER

Roll!

Son ROLLS his bright red DICE onto the map while his new friends are watching desperately.

SON

(defeated)

2!

Son hides his face behind his hands.

EVERYONE AT TABLE

Oooooooooowh....

(in harmony)

Nooooooo!

GAME MASTER

It fails and you hit yourself by accident, burning yourself in the process!

Son stands up, pretending he is on fire.

SON
(screaming in pretend
pain)
Aaaaaaaah!

EVERYONE at the table LAUGHS.

From out the living room, we see Father peeking in.
He has a wide smile on his face.
In his right eye, a tear starts to develop.

(PETER ELDRIGDE -
DIFFICULT PLAYS)

FADE TO BLACK.

THE END